

ÆTHERIUM CODEX — Complete Isotope Effect Reference

The Hidden Forge (W4): The Directed Hand

Phase Wheel: Crystal (Solid) / Chem (Liquid) / Steam (Gas) / Volt (Plasma)

Profile derivation: Crystal=Static, Chem=Cycling, Steam=Projecting, Volt=Absorbing

Diagonal pairs: Crystal↔Steam (Solid↔Gas), Chem↔Volt (Liquid↔Plasma)

****UNIQUE PROPERTY: ALL 16 Hidden Forge states are Natural (◆).**** The Forge has no internal antithetical states. Making incompatible things work together is the Forge's fundamental nature — it mediates its OWN diagonals without requiring external catalysis. Every other plane's diagonals require Forge mediation. The Forge mediates itself.

****THE FORGE'S DUAL ROLE:**** The Forge produces direct Effects (especially along the Volt axis) AND serves as the universal catalytic mediator that enables cross-planar combinations. No other plane fills both roles. The Forge version of any Effect is always the engineered/directed version — not natural expression but designed output. Forge Healing isn't biological repair; it's electrical threshold maintenance. Forge Flight isn't anti-gravity; it's propulsion engineering. Forge Illusion isn't false perception; it's hard-light construction.

F-01 — The Spire (Solid Pure / Crystal)

****Phase:**** Solid | ****Type:**** ◆ Natural | ****Profile:**** Static

Psionic resonance. Singing stones. Geometry that processes and stores information passively. The world as crystal lattice — perfect information architecture in physical form. The Crystal axis is the Forge's cognitive layer. Static because the lattice is permanent, structured, geometric — it doesn't change, it processes.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Senses**** — Information processing field. Crystal Spire materials continuously process and organize information in their environment. Records are cleaner, calculations faster, patterns more legible. THE Forge's primary perception expression.
- ****Communication**** — Information architecture. Crystal lattice as data storage and transmission medium. The structural backbone of Deepguard relay networks. Not message-sending but infrastructure-providing.
- ****Comprehend**** — Pattern recognition. The Crystal identifies, categorizes, and organizes patterns in data, language, and magical structure. Translation and decryption through geometric analysis rather than linguistic knowledge.
- ****Feature**** — Passive information processing. Items near Spire materials become organized and categorized. The workspace becomes more efficient. Operate checks gain advantage.
- ****Create**** — At specialized application, growing information architecture. Crystal structures that store and process data. The Deepguard data center as a grown artifact.

- **Enhanced Trait (mental)** — At specialized application, the Crystal processing field enhancing cognitive efficiency. Not making the user smarter — making their existing thinking more organized, faster, and less prone to error.

- **Nullify** — At specialized application, the rigid geometric structure disrupting chaotic or disorganized magical effects. Order imposed on disorder. The Crystal lattice rejects noise.

Hard Exclusions: Healing (biological), Damage (direct — the Spire processes, it doesn't strike), Growth, Speed (physical), Luck Control, Affliction (the Spire organizes — it doesn't impose conditions), Move Object.

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: Minor information processing. Operate checks advantage. Simple message storage. The Crystal hums near magical sources.

- Stage 3: Active computational field. Complex calculations performed as minor action rather than study time. Lore and Discovery checks enhanced. Deepguard relay network compatible.

- Stage 4–5: Full processing node. All information within the relay network accessible. Real-time analytical support. The item thinks alongside the wielder.

Median Expression: Senses (information processing). The Spire organizes and clarifies information in its environment.

F-02 — The Serum (Solid + Liquid / Crystal + Chem)

Phase: Solid dominant, Liquid recessive | **Type:** ♦ Natural | **Profile:** Static primary, Cycling character

Injectable magic crystals. Crystal resonance suspended in fluid and introduced directly into biological or mechanical systems. Subdermal circuitry. Witcher-style mutagens. Static (Crystal providing the information template to install) with Cycling (Chem providing the biological delivery medium). The Serum is the Forge's answer to biological magic — engineered rather than grown.

Natural Effects:

- **Enhanced Trait** — THE biological integration enhancement. Crystal information architecture delivered through chemical medium directly into biological systems. Subdermal augmentation. Implant technology. Permanent attribute modification through installed Crystal template.

- **Morph** — At specialized application, Serum-delivered template modifications. The Crystal provides the target specification; the Chem delivers it into the biological system. More precise than V-16 Mutagen because the Forge provides engineering tolerances rather than evolutionary randomness.

- **Healing** — At specialized application, biocompatible repair compounds. The Crystal

identifies the damage pattern; the Chem delivers the targeted repair agent. Forge healing is diagnostic and surgical — it fixes what it identifies rather than accelerating all biological processes.

- **Feature** — Biological compatibility. Serum materials interface with living systems without rejection. The foundation for all Forge-mediated biological augmentation. The reason Kan-tech implants don't kill the host.

- **Senses** — Biological perception enhanced through Crystal integration. Neural pathways augmented with crystalline processing. Sharpened senses through technological upgrade to existing biological hardware.

- **Affliction** — At specialized application, injecting disruptive Crystal patterns into biological systems. Bioweapon delivery through Forge precision. The offensive Serum: wrong template, right delivery.

Hard Exclusions: Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Move Object, Growth (Serum modifies template, it doesn't increase scale), Speed (physical — Serum upgrades capability, not velocity), Environment.

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: Basic biocompatible interface. Biological targets struck have magical resistances briefly legible. Minor enhancement through temporary integration.

- Stage 3: Active implant technology. Permanent attribute modification through installed Crystal template. Requires Artifice installation check. Integration is a surgical procedure.

- Stage 4–5: Full cybernetic augmentation. EML-equivalent bonus to one pillar when integrated. Item and wielder share condition track. The Serum IS part of the body now.

Median Expression: Enhanced Trait (biological integration). The Serum installs engineered upgrades into biological systems.

F-03 — Data (Solid + Plasma / Crystal + Volt)

Phase: Solid dominant, Plasma recessive | **Type:** ♦ Natural | **Profile:** Static primary, Absorbing character

Crystals storing electrical information. Memory shards. The resonance of crystal used as the medium through which electrical charge becomes retrievable, organized record. Static (Crystal holding information in permanent geometric form) with Absorbing (Volt actively recording every electrical discharge near it). The Data crystal doesn't just store what's put in — it records everything electrical that happens near it.

Natural Effects:

- **Senses** — Memory storage and perfect retrieval. Holographic playback of recorded sensory experience. THE data storage expression. One hour of perfectly recalled experience at

Stage 1.

- **Communication** — Information transmission through electrical charge in crystalline medium. Deepguard relay network compatible for remote access. Data shared across networked crystals.
- **Feature** — Unlimited information storage at high Stage. Text, full sensory experience, magical formulae — all stored as electrical pattern in crystal lattice and retrievable on demand.
- **Comprehend** — At specialized application, pattern matching against stored databases. If the Data crystal has encountered the language, cipher, or pattern before, it can translate by comparison. The library that reads for you.
- **Enhanced Trait (mental)** — At specialized application, direct access to stored knowledge temporarily enhancing the user's effective expertise. Not learning — accessing the Data crystal's stored competence. The exam cheat sheet as magical item.
- **Nullify** — At specialized application, data corruption. Introducing conflicting electrical patterns into Crystal storage to degrade or overwrite stored information. The Forge's version of targeted information warfare against artificial records (distinct from S-16 Amnesia which targets soul records).

Hard Exclusions: Healing, Damage (direct), Growth, Speed, Luck Control, Affliction (Data records — it doesn't impose conditions), Move Object, Environment.

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: Basic memory shard. One hour of sensory experience stored. Simple holographic playback to anyone holding the item. Evidence and testimony.
- Stage 3: Active data archive. Continuous environmental recording. Unlimited text, ten hours full sensory. Deepguard network compatible for remote access.
- Stage 4–5: Living database. Real-time processing node. All information within the Deepguard relay network accessible through the crystal. Search functions at wielder's Mastery + item EML.

Median Expression: Senses (data storage and retrieval). Data records everything and plays it back perfectly.

F-04 — Lens (Solid + Gas / Crystal + Steam)

Phase: Solid dominant, Gas recessive | **Type:** ♦ Natural (Forge self-mediate diagonals) | **Profile:** Static primary, Projecting character

Precision at range. Crystal geometry focusing and projecting energy through Steam pressure. Heat-rays. Concentrated directed energy. The Forge's diagonal between Crystal (Static, wants to hold and process) and Steam (Projecting, wants to expand and disperse) produces the FOCUS — energy that is both directed AND projected. The Forge holds this tension naturally because focus IS what the Forge does.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Senses**** — Focused perception at range. Telescopic vision. Microscopic analysis. THE precision observation instrument. Range increment for all detection doubled.
- ****Damage**** — Directed energy. Concentrated beam delivery. Armor-Piercing because the focused beam penetrates more efficiently than a broad attack. The Forge's precision weapon — not more powerful, more accurate.
- ****Feature**** — Range enhancement. Any ranged effect channeled through Lens gains increased range and accuracy. The universal scope attachment.
- ****Communication**** — At specialized application, focused signal transmission. Point-to-point communication through directed beam. Secure because only the receiver at the correct angle gets the signal.
- ****Nullify**** — At specialized application, focused disruption. The Lens concentrating the Forge's organizational energy into a beam that disrupts a specific magical effect at range — surgical counter-magic rather than area suppression.
- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, redirecting incoming magical projectiles. The Lens can refocus incoming directed energy and send it elsewhere. Once per encounter: choose a new target for a projectile targeting you.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing, Growth, Luck Control, Illusion (the Lens reveals through clarity — it doesn't present false images), Concealment (the Lens is the opposite — maximum visibility and precision), Affliction (the Lens doesn't impose conditions — it delivers precise effects).

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Minor range and accuracy enhancement. Precision scrying lens. Discovery advantage at range.
- Stage 3: Active directed energy. Armor-Piercing 2 on ranged weapons using Lens component. Range increment doubled. Focused counter-magic.
- Stage 4–5: Precision field. All ranged attacks originating within radius gain significant accuracy bonus. Environmental interference corrected. Incoming magical projectiles redirectable.

****Median Expression:**** Senses (precision at range) + Damage (directed energy). The Lens focuses everything — perception and destruction alike.

F-05 — The Vat (Liquid Pure / Chem)

****Phase:**** Liquid | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Cycling

Alchemical sludge. Refineries and piping. Raw chemical potential before direction is applied. Every possible transformation exists in nascent form. Cycling because the Vat IS conversion — it takes input and produces different output through chemical processing. The most fundamental Forge expression: the thing that turns one thing into another thing.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Transform**** — THE alchemical processing expression. Chemical conversion. Refining raw materials into processed products. Synthesizing compounds. Separating mixtures. The foundation of all alchemy.
- ****Create**** — Alchemical compounds. Producing specific chemical substances through controlled reaction. Medicines, adhesives, solvents, fuels, reagents.
- ****Feature**** — Universal chemical carrier. Any Substance Delivery compound applied to Vat material has doubled effect duration. The Vat acts as perfect solvent — it holds anything in solution without degrading the payload.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — At specialized application, alchemical enhancement compounds. Performance-enhancing substances through chemical processing. Potions, elixirs, stimulants. The pharmaceutical approach to Enhancement.
- ****Healing**** — At specialized application, pharmaceutical compounds for molecular repair. Chemical healing through targeted agents. Different from Font healing (biological acceleration) and Galvanism (threshold maintenance) — this is engineered molecular correction of specific damage types.
- ****Affliction**** — At specialized application, alchemical toxins. Engineered chemical disruption. Poisons, sedatives, paralytic agents. The poisoner's craft as Forge discipline.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Move Object, Growth, Speed (physical), Damage (direct — the Vat processes, it doesn't attack), Communication, Senses (the Vat converts material, it doesn't perceive).

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Basic chemical carrier. Compound duration doubled. Alchemical processing advantage. Simple synthesis.
- Stage 3: Active alchemical platform. Field alchemy possible. Compound effect checks gain bonus. Complex synthesis.
- Stage 4–5: Master synthesis. Simultaneous containment of incompatible substances in productive tension. The Vat holds two or more compounds that should destroy each other in stable coexistence. The impossible mixture.

****Median Expression:**** Transform (chemical conversion). The Vat turns one thing into another through chemistry.

F-06 — Hydraulic (Liquid + Gas / Chem + Steam)

****Phase:**** Liquid dominant, Gas recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Cycling primary, Projecting character

*Fluid dynamics driven by pressure. Power-loaders. Fluid as the medium that transmits and multiplies force. Cycling (Chem providing the incompressible medium) with Projecting (Steam

providing the pressure that the medium transmits). The hydraulic principle: small input, large output, delivered through fluid.*

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Enhanced Trait (Might)**** — THE force multiplication expression. The wielder effectively counts as one size category larger for all Might-based maneuver checks. Small inputs produce large outputs. The power-loader.
- ****Move Object**** — Pressure-driven physical manipulation. Lifting, pushing, dragging through fluid-pressure mechanics. The Forge's telekinesis analog — not mental force but mechanical force transmitted through fluid.
- ****Feature**** — Force multiplication as permanent tool property. Items with Hydraulic expression multiply the user's physical output for all leverage-based tasks. Shove and drag automatically succeed on normal hit.
- ****Damage**** — At high Stage, overwhelming hydraulic pressure as weapon. The pressure that crushes. Bludgeoning through fluid dynamics.
- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, hydraulic pressure as resistance to incoming force. Pressure-balanced armor absorbing impact by distributing it through fluid medium.
- ****Speed**** — At specialized application, hydraulic-assisted movement. The fluid medium providing assisted locomotion. Not fast — powerful in motion. The difference between quick and unstoppable.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing, Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Concealment (Hydraulic is loud — pistons, pressure, fluid noise), Senses, Communication, Growth.

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Minor force multiplication. Might-based maneuver advantage for leverage tasks. Basic power assistance.
- Stage 3: Active hydraulic enhancement. Size category increase for Might checks. Shove/Drag auto-succeed on hit. Base damage dice count doubled for force-based weapons.
- Stage 4–5: Apex hydraulic field. All Might-based checks gain bonus equal to item EML. Mechanical multiplication applied to all physical output. The industrial exosuit.

****Median Expression:**** Enhanced Trait (force multiplication). Hydraulic makes the weak strong through mechanical advantage.

F-07 — Mana-Punk (Liquid + Solid / Chem + Crystal)

****Phase:**** Liquid dominant, Solid recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Cycling primary, Static character

*Liquid magic in crystalline pipelines. Glowing blue potions flowing through geometric channels. Fluid magical energy given permanent direction and structure. The Forge's answer to magical

plumbing — the Crystal provides the channel geometry, the Chem provides the magical flow. Kan-tech infrastructure in its purest expression.*

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Feature**** — THE battery efficiency expression. Battery drain reduced per tick. Charge pools shareable between connected items. Magical conduit infrastructure enabling distributed power. The backbone of Kan-tech civilization.
- ****Communication**** — Magical infrastructure networking. Items connected through Mana-Punk expression share information and charge. The Deepguard relay network's physical medium — not the data (that's F-03 Data) but the carrier.
- ****Senses**** — At specialized application, detecting magical flow through infrastructure. Reading the power grid. Sensing where charge is flowing, pooling, and blocked. Kan-tech diagnostics.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — At specialized application, the shared charge pool providing network amplification. Multiple connected items operating at higher combined output than their individual capacities would allow.
- ****Healing**** — At specialized application, the conduit infrastructure providing consistent magical energy feed to biological systems for sustained life support. Medical infrastructure. Not treatment — maintenance.
- ****Nullify**** — At specialized application, cutting a target's connection to magical infrastructure by blocking the Mana-Punk channels they depend on. Disconnection as disruption.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Damage (direct — Mana-Punk distributes, it doesn't attack), Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Move Object, Growth, Speed, Affliction.

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Minor efficiency. Battery drain reduced by 1 per tick. Basic connection interface. Operate check advantage for magical machinery.
- Stage 3: Active junction point. Up to three connected items sharing charge pool through proximity. Network coordination established.
- Stage 4–5: Mana distribution node. All connected items draw from a single large pool. Pool size equals sum of all individual capacities. The central power station.

****Median Expression:**** Feature (battery efficiency and charge sharing). Mana-Punk makes magical infrastructure work.

F-08 — Galvanism (Liquid + Plasma / Chem + Volt)

****Phase:**** Liquid dominant, Plasma recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural (Forge self-mediate diagonals) | ****Profile:**** Cycling primary, Absorbing character

*Electricity moving through fluid. Reanimation science. Frankenstein's laboratory. The threshold

between inert matter and animation. The Forge's diagonal between Chem (Cycling, wants to convert) and Volt (Absorbing, wants to consume) — held naturally because the Forge IS the mediator. The result: the boundary between life and death becomes a Forge-managed process rather than a metaphysical absolute.*

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Healing**** — THE Forge's unique healing mechanism. Biological threshold maintenance. Electrical stimulation maintaining biological function at the boundary of death. Not tissue repair (that's V-01 World Tree) and not pharmaceutical correction (that's F-05 Vat) — this is preventing the transition from alive to dead by maintaining the electrical conditions that biological function requires. The defibrillator principle.
- ****Immortality**** — Reanimation at high Stage. The galvanic principle can restart biological function in recently deceased tissue. Not resurrection (the soul is elsewhere) — physical reactivation. The body restored to operational capacity through electrical threshold restoration. The basis of soul-drive technology and the theoretical foundation of the Harkness Engine.
- ****Damage**** — Supplemental electrical damage delivered through fluid medium. The galvanic current is simultaneously healing (at the right frequency) and destructive (at the wrong frequency). Same mechanism, different tuning.
- ****Feature**** — Biocompatible electrical interface. The material bridges electrical and biological systems without rejection. The foundation of all Forge-biological hybrid technology. Organic struck by Galvanism heals 1 HP from the galvanic stimulus.
- ****Affliction**** — At specialized application, galvanic disruption. Electrical stimulation at deliberately wrong frequency disrupting biological function. Nerve interference. Cardiac disruption. Muscle seizure. The offensive defibrillator.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — At specialized application, galvanic stimulation temporarily enhancing biological performance through electrical activation of dormant muscular and neural capacity. The adrenaline shot as Forge technology.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Growth, Create, Move Object, Concealment (galvanic discharge is visible — arcs and sparks), Comprehend.

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Minor galvanic effect. Supplemental electrical damage. Organic targets struck receive mild healing stimulus. Biocompatible interface established.
- Stage 3: Active threshold maintenance. Dying creatures stabilized with standard action. Biological function maintained at death boundary for one hour. Operate check TN 20 for recently deceased restoration.
- Stage 4–5: Full reanimation capacity. The death boundary becomes a Forge-managed transition rather than a binary state. Soul-drive integration possible. The Galvanic field keeps biology running regardless of whether the occupant is present.

****Median Expression:**** Healing (threshold maintenance). Galvanism keeps things alive at the boundary by maintaining the electrical conditions biology requires.

F-09 — The Engine (Gas Pure / Steam)

****Phase:**** Gas | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Projecting

Massive pistons, gears, heat, brass. Pressure as the fundamental fact. The industrial heartbeat. Pure Steam — the Forge's most basic and most reliable form. Projecting because Steam distributes energy outward through pressure, reaching every connected component. The Engine doesn't innovate — it works. Consistently, reliably, industrially.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Feature**** — THE mechanical reliability expression. Never jams. Never misfires. Never requires clearing malfunctions. The Engine works because working is its nature. THE fundamental Forge guarantee — the item functions as designed, every time, without exception.
- ****Quickness**** — Process acceleration through mechanical efficiency. Tasks performed faster because the mechanism is optimized. Not velocity — throughput. The assembly line that produces more per hour.
- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, mechanical reliability applied to defensive systems. Armor that never fails to deploy. Shields that always activate on trigger. Defensive mechanisms with zero malfunction rate. Not stronger defense — more reliable defense.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — At specialized application, sustained mechanical assistance providing consistent physical output enhancement. Not burst power (that's Steampunk F-10) — consistent, reliable, sustained assistance. The power suit that works all day.
- ****Create**** — At specialized application, mechanical fabrication. Mass production of standardized components. Consistent quality. Reproducible results. The assembly line.
- ****Communication**** — At specialized application, mechanical timing as communication medium. Pressure pulses. Regular rhythmic signals. The telegraph principle.
- ****Senses**** — At specialized application, mechanical sensing through pressure and vibration detection. The Engine feels disruptions in its mechanical environment. Tremorsense through machinery.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing (biological), Luck Control, Illusion, Concealment (the Engine is loud — pistons, rhythm, pressure release), Growth, Teleport, Affliction (the Engine doesn't impose conditions — it works).

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Basic reliability. Item operates with industrial consistency. Firearms and crossbows never require clearing. Minor process acceleration.
- Stage 3: Active reliability field. All crafting checks gain advantage when using the item as tool. Efficient engine halves Active Component drain rate.
- Stage 4–5: Engine heart. Up to five additional items draw power simultaneously. Functions as universal battery type for all connected items. The central drive shaft.

****Median Expression:**** Feature (reliability). The Engine guarantees that things work.

F-10 — Steampunk (Gas + Plasma / Steam + Volt)

****Phase:**** Gas dominant, Plasma recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Projecting primary, Absorbing character

Pressure married to electricity. Tesla coils powered by coal. Weird science. Both forces simultaneously present and barely controlled. Projecting (Steam distributing pressure outward) with Absorbing (Volt concentrating electrical energy). Greater output than either alone, at correspondingly reduced stability. The Forge's performance car — faster and louder and more likely to catch fire.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Damage**** — THE Forge's primary direct damage expression. Both pressure (fire) and electrical damage simultaneously. Each damage type applies to Soak separately — if the target resists fire but not electrical, they still take the electrical. Dual-element destruction.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — Overclocked performance. Pushing systems beyond rated capacity. Spend Stamina to double output for one action. The item moves one step down condition track after overclocking. Spectacular visual output — sparks, steam, lightning.
- ****Feature**** — Dual-energy output. Both pressure and electrical force available simultaneously. Versatile but the stability cost is real. Visual spectacle accompanies all uses.
- ****Affliction**** — At high Stage, overload conditions. Target systems overwhelmed by sympathetic energy cascade. Circuits burn. Pressure seals fail. Kan-tech in proximity malfunctions from energy bleed.
- ****Environment**** — At high Stage, electrified pressure field. Area effect of both pressure spikes and electrical discharge. Dangerous to everyone in range including the wielder. The Tesla coil room.
- ****Weaken**** — At specialized application, forcing more energy through a target system than it can handle. Degrading function through overload rather than through damage.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing, Concealment (Steampunk is maximally visible and audible — sparks and steam), Luck Control, Illusion, Teleport, Growth, Protection (Steampunk is offense-focused — it produces, not preserves).

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Mild dual-energy. Both fire and electrical supplemental damage on hit. Each at half normal but both applying separately.
- Stage 3: Active overclocking available. Double damage output at condition track cost. Spectacular combat presence. System disruption begins on targets.
- Stage 4–5: Storm-engine. Continuous excess energy arcing to nearest conductor each round.

Adjacent metal-wearing targets take automatic bonus damage. Wielder immune. Concerned social situations.

****Median Expression:**** Damage (dual energy). Steampunk hits with fire and lightning simultaneously.

F-11 — Diesel (Gas + Liquid / Steam + Chem)

****Phase:**** Gas dominant, Liquid recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Projecting primary, Cycling character

Combustion pressure driving fluid mechanics. Smog, oil, rust, treads. The working-class Forge. Projecting (Steam distributing pressure) with Cycling (Chem providing the fuel medium that sustains the pressure). A closed loop: pressure moves fuel, fuel sustains pressure. Not fast, not flashy, not glamorous. Reliable, sustained, ugly, effective. Setting B's industrial backbone.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Feature**** — THE sustained operation expression. Item never depletes completely — maintains minimum charge of 1 regardless of use. Recharge rate doubled. The Diesel loop is self-sustaining. At Stage 5, drain rate becomes zero. The never-stop engine.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — Endurance and exhaustion immunity. The Diesel rhythm keeps the wielder going past biological limits. Not stronger — relentless. The march that doesn't end.
- ****Quickness**** — At specialized application, sustained throughput rather than burst speed. The marathon runner rather than the sprinter. Consistent production over long duration.
- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, sustained defensive function at minimum effectiveness regardless of damage. The armor that never fully fails. Doesn't excel at any point — never reaches zero.
- ****Healing**** — At specialized application, sustained biological maintenance. Not repair — maintenance. The metabolic support that keeps the body running when it should have stopped. Crude, reliable, ugly. The field medic's engine.
- ****Affliction**** — The persistent environmental cost. Smell of oil and exhaust. Social penalty in refined company. Environmental contamination in sustained deployment. The price of industrial endurance.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Teleport, Luck Control, Illusion, Growth, Damage (direct — Diesel sustains, it doesn't strike), Concealment (Diesel is audible, visible, and especially smellable), Senses, Communication.

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Basic sustained operation. Item never fully depletes. Recharge rate doubled. Distinctive oily smell.
- Stage 3: Active endurance field. Full effectiveness at minimum charge. Exhaustion immunity

for welder. Sustained operation without rest.

- Stage 4–5: Never-stop engine. Active Component drain rate becomes zero. The Diesel loop is self-sustaining. Cost: item cannot be upgraded or modified while in this state without full factory rebuild.

****Median Expression:**** Feature (sustained operation). Diesel keeps running and never stops.

F-12 — Aether-Tech (Gas + Solid / Steam + Crystal)

****Phase:**** Gas dominant, Solid recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural (Forge self-mediate diagonals)
| ****Profile:**** Projecting primary, Static character

Pressure and resonance forced into combination. Magic ships running on solar sails. Brass vessels floating in space. The Forge's diagonal between Steam (Projecting, wants to expand in all directions) and Crystal (Static, wants to hold in place) — held naturally because the Forge IS the mediator. The result: pressure that has been given geometric direction. The Steam wants to expand everywhere; the Crystal collimates it into a single vector. Directed propulsion.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Flight**** — THE Forge's flight expression. Sustained directional propulsion through pressure focused by Crystal geometry. Not anti-gravity (that's Palimpsest narrative logic overriding physics) and not biological flight (that requires Borderlands Air interaction with Font-grown wings). This is ENGINEERING flight — lift and thrust generated, directed, and maintained through Forge process.

- ****Speed**** — Enhanced movement through propulsion assistance. Reduced effective weight plus directional force. The item doesn't make the welder lighter — it pushes them where they want to go.

- ****Feature**** — Effective weightlessness. Encumbrance contribution zero. Item floats at welder's shoulder when not held. The hover-item.

- ****Environment**** — At high Stage, the Aether-Tech field provides pressure immunity and atmospheric protection. Functions as environmental suit in hostile conditions. The spacesuit principle.

- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, the directional force field providing deflection. Not absorption — redirection. Incoming projectiles deflected by the pressure-crystal field. The deflection shield.

- ****Senses**** — At specialized application, Crystal geometry providing navigational awareness. Orientation, altitude, velocity, heading — the Crystal tracks positional data. The compass that always knows where you are.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing, Luck Control, Illusion, Concealment (the Aether-Tech field is visible — shimmer, pressure distortion), Growth, Affliction, Damage (direct — Aether-Tech propels, it doesn't attack).

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Effective weightlessness. Item floats. Encumbrance zero. Minor speed enhancement. Assisted jumping (30 ft gaps as swift action).
- Stage 3: Active propulsion. Sustained flight at movement speed for battery-capacity-in-minutes duration. Intuitive navigation. Basic atmospheric protection.
- Stage 4–5: Full Aether-Tech flight. Sustained, long-duration, environment-independent. Pressure immunity. Atmospheric suit function. The skyship engine.

****Median Expression:**** Flight (engineered propulsion). Aether-Tech makes things fly through directed pressure.

F-13 — The Grid (Plasma Pure / Volt)

****Phase:**** Plasma | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Absorbing

Pure electricity. Living lightning. The state where electrical force has become environmental rather than generated. Absorbing because the Volt draws electrical energy inward, concentrating it until discharge is inevitable. The Grid doesn't decide to arc — it can't NOT arc. The charge IS the material.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Damage**** — THE Forge's pure destructive expression. Continuous electrical arc to any conducting material within range. This is NOT optional — the charge is the material's nature. Living lightning as a permanent state. The most direct damage expression in the Forge.
- ****Feature**** — Chain discharge. Electrical arc jumps to nearest metal-wearing creature within range as free action each round. Metal armor, weapons, and items in proximity are potential secondary targets for discharge. Cannot be suppressed — the charge is the material.
- ****Senses**** — Electrical field detection. Sense all conductors, all electrical activity, all charge differentials within range. The Grid is aware of its entire electrical environment. Metal detection as passive perception.
- ****Affliction**** — Electrical stun. Nervous system disruption. Muscle seizure. Cardiac interference at high Stage. System overload on constructs and Kan-tech devices.
- ****Nullify**** — At specialized application, electrical overload. Flooding magical or mechanical systems with uncontrolled charge. Burning circuits. Disrupting enchantments by overloading their power systems.
- ****Enhanced Trait**** — At specialized application, the Grid's electrical field enhancing nervous system response time. Faster reflexes. Improved initiative. Electrical augmentation of reaction speed.
- ****Weaken**** — At specialized application, sustained electrical degradation of systems. Circuit burning. Component failure through overcharge. Kan-tech disruption through power surge.

****Hard Exclusions:**** Healing (the Grid is destructive electrical force, not therapeutic), Concealment (lightning is maximally visible — flash, thunder, ozone), Protection (physical), Luck Control, Illusion, Growth, Create, Teleport.

****Formation Stage Shift:****

- Stage 1–2: Living charge. Mild arc to nearest metal within 5 ft each round. 1d4 electrical damage. Cannot be suppressed.
- Stage 3: Active discharge field. Chain arc to secondary targets on critical hit. Grid tap — absorbs incoming electrical damage and converts to charges for later release.
- Stage 4–5: Lightning rod. ALL electrical effects within range drawn through the item. Total electrical damage immunity for wielder. Any discharge in range redirectable to wielder's chosen target as reaction.

****Median Expression:**** Damage (electrical) + Feature (chain). The Grid is living lightning that arcs to everything conductive in range.

F-14 — Cyberpunk (Plasma + Solid / Volt + Crystal)

****Phase:**** Plasma dominant, Solid recessive | ****Type:**** ♦ Natural | ****Profile:**** Absorbing primary, Static character

Electricity meeting crystalline resonance. Neon lights. Holograms. Hard-light constructs. Laser systems. The Volt's energy given Crystal's geometric permanence — electricity that holds its shape. Absorbing (Volt concentrating electrical energy) with Static (Crystal giving that energy permanent geometric form). The result: persistent, shaped light with physical interaction properties.

****Natural Effects:****

- ****Illusion**** — THE Forge's illusion expression. Hard-light projection. Not false perception (that's Palimpsest) — actual light-constructs with geometric structure and physical interaction properties. Visually perfect, structurally real. Indistinguishable from reality to unaided senses.
- ****Create**** — Hard-light construction. Barriers, shields, furniture, tools, structures made of persistent shaped electrical light. Physical properties (Soak, HP). Shaped to specification. Duration limited by power.
- ****Feature**** — Hard-light projection on demand. Geometric light constructs shaped by will. The versatile crafting material that's made of light. Torch that can be molded into any shape or tool.
- ****Senses**** — At specialized application, holographic display. Information presented as three-dimensional visual construct. The Heads-Up Display. Tactical overlay.
- ****Communication**** — At specialized application, holographic communication. Visual messages shaped in light. Remote visual presence. The video call as magical technology.
- ****Protection**** — At specialized application, hard-light barriers providing physical defense. The energy shield. Stage 3: 10-ft cube constructs with Soak 2 and HP 20. Shapeable as armor,

barriers, or terrain.

- **Concealment** — At specialized application, hard-light projection disguising appearance. The technological disguise. Detectable as energy construct by analysis but visually perfect to casual observation.

Hard Exclusions: Healing, Luck Control, Growth, Teleport, Speed (Cyberpunk creates, it doesn't accelerate), Affliction (hard-light is constructive, not condition-imposing), Damage (direct — hard-light has physical properties but isn't optimized for destruction. Use F-04 Lens for directed energy damage).

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: Minor hard-light. Geometric light construct on demand. Functions as torch. Can be shaped into simple blocking forms (shield, wall segment) deflecting thrown objects.
- Stage 3: Full holographic interface. Visually perfect illusion within 10 ft. Hard-light structures up to 10-ft cube with material properties. Duration: one hour per battery charge.
- Stage 4–5: Persistent hard-light architecture. Structures of significant size and complexity. Near-permanent duration. The holographic city as physical reality.

Median Expression: Illusion (hard-light) + Create (light constructs). Cyberpunk makes things out of shaped light that function as real.

F-15 — Clockwork (Plasma + Gas / Volt + Steam)

Phase: Plasma dominant, Gas recessive | **Type:** ♦ Natural | **Profile:** Absorbing primary, Projecting character

Electricity driving pressure mechanics with supreme precision. Precision droids. Automatons wound by lightning keys. The Volt provides the motive energy; the Steam transmits it through pressure mechanics. The result: mechanical action with perfect timing and zero tolerance. The Forge's most philosophically significant isotope — Clockwork approaches probability not through magic but through engineering.

Natural Effects:

- **Quickness** — THE precision timing expression. Extremely regular, high-frequency timing pulse. Mechanical systems in proximity become more precise. Initiative bonus equal to item EML. Cosmological accuracy in timekeeping.
- **Luck Control** — Mechanical determinism. Not fate manipulation — CALCULATION. The Clockwork computes outcomes by running physics forward with perfect precision. The wielder can declare one action per encounter as "inevitable" because the Clockwork has already calculated the exact sequence of physical events needed. The result is predetermined not by magic but by engineering. The Chronosynclastic Institute's philosophical foundation: probability is just insufficiently computed physics.

- **Feature** — Perfect timing accuracy. Programmable routine — up to three sequential actions encoded and triggered on command, executing with zero deviation regardless of external interference.
- **Senses** — At specialized application, predictive analysis. The Clockwork computing future physical states from current conditions. Not prophecy (P-10 sees what WILL happen through fate) — Clockwork calculates what SHOULD happen through physics. When both agree, certainty approaches absolute.
- **Enhanced Trait** — At specialized application, the Clockwork timing providing optimal action timing. Every movement at the mechanically ideal moment. Maximum efficiency without enhanced force.
- **Nullify** — At specialized application, disrupting timing-dependent processes by imposing the Clockwork's own timing cycle. Overriding enemy action sequences. Forcing mechanical rhythm onto organic or chaotic systems.

Hard Exclusions: Healing, Growth, Illusion, Concealment, Teleport, Damage (direct — Clockwork is precision, not force), Create (physical), Move Object, Affliction (Clockwork doesn't impose conditions — it calculates outcomes).

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: Perfect timepiece. Initiative bonus. Programmable routine with single encoded action. Minor timing optimization.
- Stage 3: Active determinism. Three-action programmable routine. One "inevitable" declaration per encounter. Predictive analysis available.
- Stage 4–5: Fate mechanism. The Clockwork's computational model is sophisticated enough that the distinction between "calculated" and "fated" becomes academic. The item knows what happens next because it has computed every variable.

Median Expression: Quickness (precision timing) + Luck Control (mechanical determinism). Clockwork calculates the future and makes it happen.

F-16 — Battery (Plasma + Liquid / Volt + Chem)

Phase: Plasma dominant, Liquid recessive | **Type:** ♦ Natural (Forge self-mediate diagonals) | **Profile:** Absorbing primary, Cycling character

Electrical plasma forced into fluid containment. Acid-based energy storage. Contained, dangerous, essential. The Forge's diagonal between Volt (Absorbing, concentrating energy to destructive levels) and Chem (Cycling, converting between states through fluid process) — held naturally because the Forge IS the mediator. The result: enormous energy stored in stable but dangerous chemical-electrical medium. The foundation of all Powered items.

Natural Effects:

- **Feature** — THE energy storage expression. Item battery capacity doubled. Recharge rate doubled. Passive recharge of nearby compatible items. The fundamental power source for all Powered items in the system. Without Battery expression, there is no Kan-tech civilization.
- **Enhanced Trait** — At specialized application, power amplification. The Battery providing surplus energy to connected systems, enabling them to operate at higher output than their own capacity allows. The booster pack.
- **Damage** — At specialized application, battery discharge as weapon. Concentrated release of stored electrical+chemical energy. Powerful single-shot but depletes the source. The capacitor dump.
- **Affliction** — Chemical corrosion as persistent side effect. The Battery's chemical component corrodes organic materials on prolonged contact. Acrid smell. The cost of portable power storage.
- **Create** — At specialized application, producing power cells. Manufacturing portable energy storage units. The Battery making batteries. Recursive infrastructure.
- **Feature (critical risk)** — Explosive failure. If fully depleted in a single encounter, the chemical-electrical tension the Forge holds in balance can catastrophically release. Vigor check for welder or take fire+acid damage from catastrophic decompression. This isn't a flaw — it's an inherent property. Batteries are powerful because they're dangerous.

Hard Exclusions: Healing, Luck Control, Illusion, Teleport, Growth, Concealment, Senses (the Battery stores energy, it doesn't perceive), Communication (the Battery powers things, it doesn't transmit).

Formation Stage Shift:

- Stage 1–2: High-capacity storage. Battery capacity doubled. Recharge doubled. Chemical corrosion on prolonged organic contact. Acrid smell.
- Stage 3: Power amplifier. Adds own capacity to any connected item's pool through proximity. Contact corrosion no longer required for connection — proximity within 5 ft suffices.
- Stage 4–5: Independent power station. Up to five connected items simultaneously. 200-charge pool. Explosive failure risk if fully depleted in single encounter. The portable reactor.

Median Expression: Feature (energy storage). Battery stores power and makes it available.

HIDDEN FORGE SUMMARY — Effect Coverage

THE FORGE IS CATEGORICALLY DIFFERENT. Every other plane produces Effects that express its nature directly. The Forge produces Effects AND mediates other planes' Effects. This dual role means the Forge's Effect coverage appears wider than any other plane — but the Forge's version of each Effect is always the ENGINEERED version, achieved through process rather than natural expression.

****Effects the Forge EXCELS at:** Feature (the Forge's broadest domain — reliability, efficiency, infrastructure, timing, power storage, sustained operation, force multiplication), Senses (precision observation, data storage, information processing, electrical detection — the Crystal axis), Communication (data transmission, relay networks, infrastructure networking — Crystal+Steam systems), Enhanced Trait (through augmentation rather than natural enhancement — Serum implants, Hydraulic force multiplication, Steampunk overclocking, Diesel endurance), Damage (directed energy — Lens precision, Grid electrical, Steampunk dual-element), Quickness (process acceleration and precision timing — Engine reliability, Clockwork determinism)**

****Effects the Forge CAN produce (engineered versions):** Healing (three distinct mechanisms — Galvanism threshold maintenance, Vat pharmaceutical correction, Serum diagnostic repair, Diesel biological maintenance, Mana-Punk life support — NONE of which are biological acceleration), Flight (Aether-Tech propulsion — engineering, not magic), Illusion (Cyberpunk hard-light — construction, not perception), Transform (Vat chemical conversion — chemistry, not transmutation), Create (Vat compounds, Cyberpunk hard-light, Engine mass production — manufactured, not conjured), Luck Control (Clockwork mechanical determinism — calculation, not fate manipulation), Morph (Serum template installation — surgery, not shapeshifting), Immortality (Galvanism reanimation — threshold maintenance, not soul management), Protection (Engine reliable defense, Hydraulic pressure-balanced armor, Cyberpunk energy shields, Aether-Tech deflection), Nullify (Lens focused disruption, Grid electrical overload, Spire order-imposition, Data corruption, Mana-Punk disconnection)**

****Effects the Forge CANNOT produce:** Growth (the Forge doesn't change scale — it changes efficiency), Regeneration (sustained biological repair is Font territory — the Forge can maintain thresholds but not rebuild tissue over time), Panacea (broad-spectrum biological cure requires Font Generative expression), Teleport (the Forge can build vehicles but not fold space), Dimensional Travel (planar transit requires Palimpsest mechanism), Time Travel (temporal manipulation is beyond engineering), Affliction (biological conditions — the Forge doesn't sicken, it disrupts systems), Concealment (most Forge expressions are loud, visible, and detectable — industrial noise, electrical signature, mechanical rhythm)**

****THE FORGE'S UNIQUE CONTRIBUTION:** The Forge is the only plane that appears in EVERY cross-planar combination as the mediating catalyst. Without the Forge, the antithetical combinations (Borderlands↔Palimpsest, Verdant Font↔Synod) produce Forbidden or Paradox states rather than functional materials. The Forge's Effect list is less important than its CATALYTIC FUNCTION — it makes everything else work together.**